

Conversion & Growth Case Study

Lifting Live-Commerce Conversion 12.5% Through Funnel Analysis and Structured Experimentation

One-line judgement: Growth wasn't a single big idea — it was finding **where** buyers dropped off and running disciplined experiments there, instead of shipping features and hoping.

Role & Scope

Role: Lead Product Manager

Product: The B2C purchase funnel on Baidu's live-commerce platform (a £2M+ daily GMV business).

Scope: Funnel and user-journey analysis, opportunity sizing, targeting logic, experiment design and read-out, cross-functional delivery with engineering, data and design.

Context

On a high-traffic live-commerce platform, small conversion changes move large absolute GMV. But "improve conversion" is not a plan — it's a wish. Traffic was strong; the question was where, along the path from entering a live room to completing a purchase, intent was leaking.

Problem

The problem was not *"we need more traffic."* It was:

"Buyers arrive with intent, but drop off somewhere between the live room and checkout — and we don't know precisely where or why."

Without a segmented view of the funnel, any feature is a guess. The first job was to make the drop-offs visible and rank them by opportunity.

Insight

The biggest conversion gains weren't behind a new feature — they were behind **removing specific, measurable friction at the highest-leverage step of the funnel**, validated by experiment rather than opinion.

Strategic Decisions

1. **Segment the funnel, then attack the highest-leverage leak.** **[CONFIRM]** I broke the purchase journey into stages, quantified drop-off at each, and prioritised the steps where a fix would move the most GMV — rather than spreading effort across every idea.
2. **Targeting logic, so the right users see the right intervention.** **[CONFIRM]** Not every buyer needs the same nudge. Applying targeting to conversion interventions meant experiments were sharper and effects clearer.
3. **Decide by experiment, not by opinion.** I ran a **structured programme of 12 A/B tests over six weeks**, so that what shipped was what the data supported — and effects were attributable, not anecdotal.

Trade-offs

The core trade-off was **speed vs. attributable learning**. Shipping a bundle of changes at once is faster and **feels** productive, but you learn nothing about what worked. Running structured experiments is slower per change but compounds: every test sharpens the model of where value actually is. I chose disciplined experimentation, because on a large-GMV funnel, knowing **why** a number moved is what lets you move it again.

Outcomes & Impact

- **Conversion (CVR) up 12.5%** and **GMV up 6.8%** on the B2C purchase funnel — meaningful absolute value at £2M+ daily GMV scale.
- Delivered through **12 A/B tests over six weeks**, giving an attributable, repeatable model of where funnel value sat. **[CONFIRM]**
- Built a funnel-analysis and experimentation practice the team could keep using after this programme. **[CONFIRM]**

What I Learned

- **"Improve growth" becomes tractable the moment you segment the funnel.** The win is choosing the right step, not having the cleverest feature.
- **Experimentation is how growth compounds.** Attributable learning beats a faster but unexplained result — especially on a funnel where the same lever can be pulled again across markets.
- **Targeting turns a blunt nudge into a sharp one.** Who sees an intervention is as much a product decision as what the intervention is.